



AUDIO BUFFER LONDON — SESSION #02

"Show us your screens."

Guillaume Piccarreta — gcode · Paris

Friday, April 24 — 4:00 PM · H.O.M.E. London

online: gcode.tools/audio-buffer

website: gcode.tools · instagram: [@_gcode](https://www.instagram.com/_gcode)

> whoami

guillaume.piccarreta @ audio-buffer:~/london\$

// session #02 — live coding

"Obscurantism is dangerous. Show us your screens."

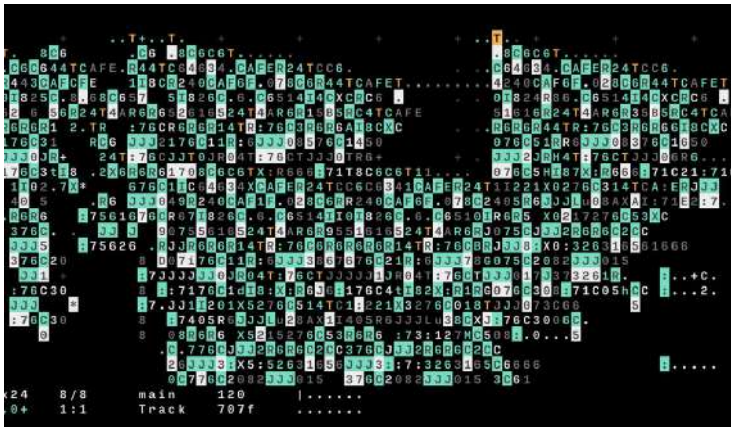
```
// intro
```

Audio Buffer London – Live Coding

Live coding is the practice of writing and changing code while it runs, making programming itself a visible, performative act.

In live coding performances, **source code is projected** and becomes part of the artistic material, alongside sound, visuals, and timing.

It creates a **shared, transparent space** where algorithms are composed, modified, and interpreted in real time.



```
> goto intro
```

```
→ moved to 1. intro
```

```
// projecting source code as artistic material
```

```
"Give us access to the performer's mind, to the whole human instrument."
```

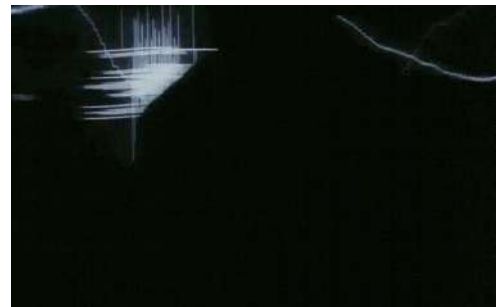
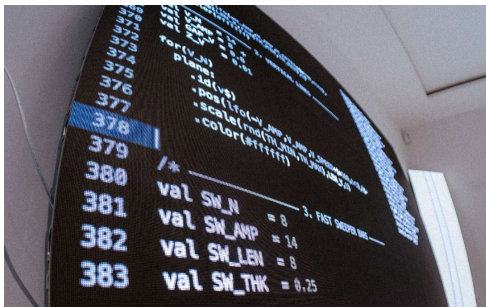


```
// whoami
```

whoami

Guillaume Piccarreta (gcode) is a programmer, musician, and digital artist exploring the interaction between sound and image. After studying digital art at Paris Panthéon-Sorbonne University, he lived in Tokyo for four years, where he developed creative applications, audiovisual performances, and interactive installations. He currently works at [IRCAM](#), contributing to projects that bring together artists and researchers around new forms of sonic experimentation. Through his project **gcode**, he explores the relationships between generative algorithms, process-based aesthetics, and computational tools, expressed through audiovisual performances, installations, and workshops within the live coding and digital art communities.

instagram: [@_.gcode](#) • website: [gcode.tools](#)



```
> cat ~/.bio
```

```
guillaume.piccarreta — gcode
```

```
// generative algorithms • process aesthetics • audiovisual performance
```

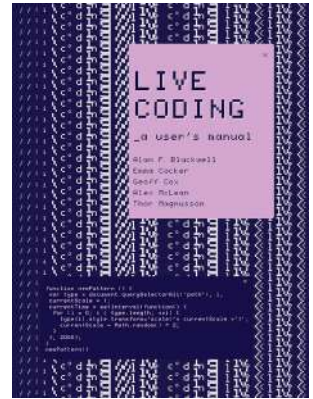
```
"Programs are instruments that can change themselves."
```

```
// live coding 101
```

live coding 101

Live coding can be understood as **real-time software writing**: changing a running program, composing through code, and exposing process as performance.

In [Live Coding: A User's Manual](#) (MIT Press, 2022), the practice is described as "*thinking in public*," where writing and rewriting code becomes visible, improvisatory, and open-ended.



Live Coding: A User's Manual (MIT Press, 2022)



manifesto draft (toplap) ↗

- "Obscurantism is dangerous. Show us your screens."
- Give us access to the performer's mind, to the whole human instrument.
- Programs are instruments that can change themselves.
- The program is to be transcended – Artificial language is the way.
- Code should be seen as well as heard, underlying algorithms viewed as well as their visual outcome.
- Live coding is not about tools. Algorithms are thoughts. Chainsaws are tools.

Λ L G
Ø △ R
Λ V E

algorave ↗

Algorave is made from sounds "*wholly or predominantly characterised by the emission of a succession of repetitive conditionals.*"

It breaks barriers between writing algorithms and making dance music live: humans compose in real time with code, and the dancefloor closes the loop.

platforms

- [SuperCollider](#)
- [Tidal Cycles](#)
- [Strudel](#)
- [Orca](#)
- [Sova](#)

resources

- [TOPLAP](#)
- [ManifestoDraft](#)
- [livecoding.fr](#)
- [International Conference on Live Coding \(ICLC\)](#)
- [Live coding talk \(YouTube\)](#)

```
> cat manifesto.txt
```

```
→ TOPLAP • since 2004 • algorave • since 2011
```

```
// process > product • errors are creative material
```

```
"The program is to be transcended – Artificial language is the way."
```

```
// why
```

why

Live coding is also an **inclusive community practice**. It creates spaces where **artists, developers, and students** can learn from each other across disciplines.

It supports **collaboration with other artists**, helps people become familiar with code, and **demystifies programming by making process visible**.

- **Process over product** – the audience witnesses ideas becoming form.
- Compact rules can produce rich and evolving sonic structures.
- Errors become creative material instead of backstage problems.
- Improvisation is framed by explicit algorithmic constraints.



```
> why()
```

```
→ shared learning • cross-disciplinary • collaborative
```

```
// audience witnesses ideas becoming form
```

```
"Code should be seen as well as heard."
```

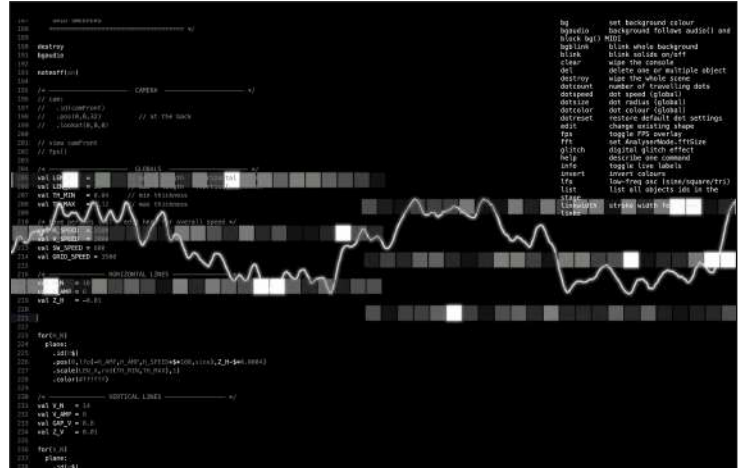
// events

events

Selected events from live coding performances across clubs, art spaces, and educational contexts.



IRCAM Improtech – live coding practices



OCC – live coding excerpt



algorave 2025



gcode a/v live – RiCO Collective (Paris, 2025)

► video archive • visit: <https://gcode.tools/audio-buffer/#events>

> ls events/

ircam-improtech • occ-live • algorave-2025 • gcode-rico

// open video archive at gcode.tools/audio-buffer

"Live coding is not about tools. Algorithms are thoughts."

audio-buffer • session #02 • london • 2026

06 / 08


```
// occ
```

OCC

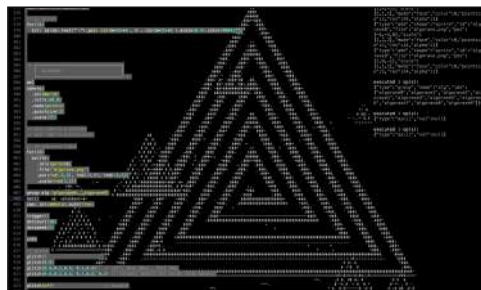
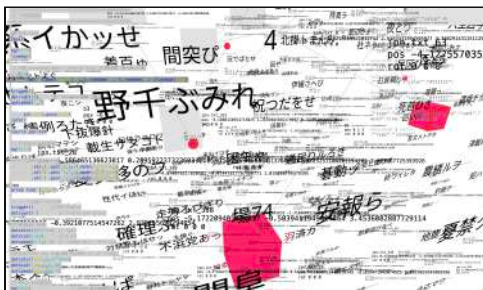
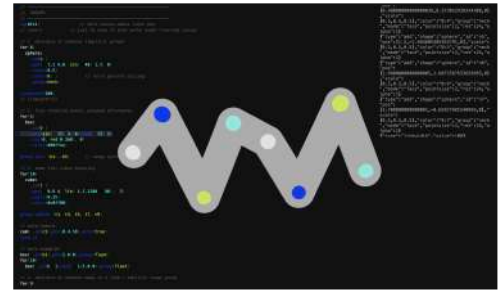
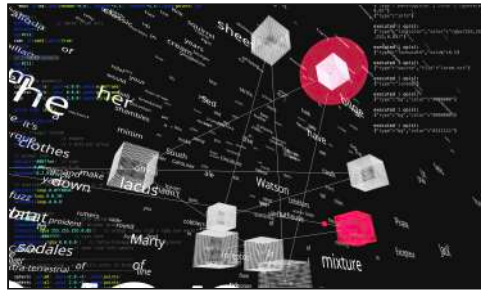
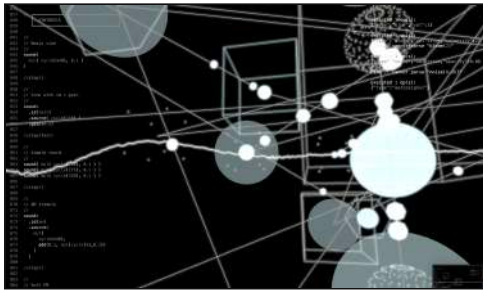
→ gcode.tools/occ

OCC is a **live coding environment for audiovisual performance**. You write short code blocks and execute them in real time.

- **Visual scene and audio engine** are controlled from the same language.
- Commands are designed to stay **compact while performing**.
- Switch from **object-level coding** to **macro sequencing** with the 4×4 grid.

Live process

- Reset and set a base camera.
- Start one or more audio layers (sound, inst, seq).
- Add visual groups and triggers.
- Move across scripts with grid commands.



```
> launch occ
```

```
→ audio + visual
```

```
// gcode.tools/occ
```

```
"Algorithms are thoughts. Chainsaws are tools."
```

thx.

Guillaume Piccarreta — gcode

gcode.tools · @.gcode
gcode.tools/audio-buffer

> exit

→ thanks! questions, ideas welcome

// audio-buffer · session #02 · london

"Code should be seen as well as heard."
